

```
"""
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```
38 CFR Part 4 - Schedule for Rating Disabilities
```

```
Complete conditions database with diagnostic codes, rating criteria,
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```
DBQ examination questions, secondary condition flags, and C&P exam tips.
```

```
"""
```

```
CONDITIONS_DB = {
```

```
# _____
```

```
# MUSCULOSKELETAL SYSTEM (DC 5000-5299)
```

```
# _____
```

```
"cervical_strain": {
```

```
    "name": "Cervical Strain (Neck)",
```

```
    "diagnostic_code": "5237",
```

```
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
```

```
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5237",
```

```
    "rating_criteria": {
```

```
        100: "Unfavorable ankylosis of the entire spine",
```

```
        50: "Unfavorable ankylosis of entire cervical spine",
```

```
        30: "Favorable ankylosis of entire cervical spine, or forward flexio
```

```
        20: "Forward flexion of cervical spine greater than 15° but not grea
```

```
        10: "Forward flexion of cervical spine greater than 30° but not grea
```

```
        0: "Forward flexion greater than 40°, or combined range of motion g
```

```
    },
```

```
    "key_measurements": [
```

```
        "Forward flexion (normal: 45°)",
```

```
        "Extension (normal: 45°)",
```

```
        "Left lateral flexion (normal: 45°)",
```

```
        "Right lateral flexion (normal: 45°)",
```

```
        "Left rotation (normal: 80°)",
```

```
        "Right rotation (normal: 80°)",
```

```
    ],
```

```
    "dbq_questions": [
```

```
        "What is the forward flexion of your cervical spine (looking down)?",
```

```
        "Do you have muscle spasms in your neck?",
```

```
        "Do you have guarding – stiffness that limits how you move your neck?",
```

```
        "Does the pain radiate into your shoulders, arms, or hands?",
```

```
        "Does your neck condition affect your ability to work or perform dail
```

```
        "Have you received any imaging (X-ray, MRI) for your neck?",
```

```
        "Do you have any neurological symptoms – numbness, tingling, weakness
```

```
    ],
```

```
    "secondary_conditions": [
```

```
        "thoracic_strain",
```

```

        "headaches_migraines",
        "peripheral_neuropathy",
        "sleep_impairment",
        "depression",
    ],
    "exam_tips": [
        "Be measured on your WORST day – not an average day.",
        "Report all radicular symptoms (shooting pain, numbness, tingling) se
        "Bring your STRs (Service Treatment Records) showing neck complaints
        "Mention how the condition affects your work – specifically if you ca
        "If you have muscle spasms, make sure the examiner documents them – t
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Your nexus letter should note any in-service incidents (vehicle acci
        "Chronic neck pain following a documented in-service fall, motor vehi
    ],
},

"lumbosacral_strain": {
    "name": "Lumbosacral Strain (Lower Back)",
    "diagnostic_code": "5237",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5237",
    "rating_criteria": {
        100: "Unfavorable ankylosis of the entire spine",
        50: "Unfavorable ankylosis of entire thoracolumbar spine",
        40: "Unfavorable ankylosis of thoracolumbar spine",
        20: "Forward flexion of the thoracolumbar spine 30° or less, or favo
        10: "Forward flexion of the thoracolumbar spine greater than 30° but
        0: "Forward flexion of the thoracolumbar spine greater than 60°, or
    },
    "key_measurements": [
        "Forward flexion (normal: 90°)",
        "Extension (normal: 30°)",
        "Left lateral flexion (normal: 30°)",
        "Right lateral flexion (normal: 30°)",
        "Left rotation (normal: 30°)",
        "Right rotation (normal: 30°)",
    ],
    "dbq_questions": [
        "What is the forward flexion of your lumbar spine – how far can you b
        "Do you have muscle spasms in your lower back?",
        "Do you have an abnormal gait (limping or altered walk) because of yo
        "Does pain radiate into your buttocks, legs, or feet (sciatica)?",
        "Do you have intervertebral disc disease, herniated disc, or degenera
        "How does the condition affect your daily life – standing, sitting, s
        "Do you have bladder or bowel problems associated with your back?",
    ],

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```

],
"secondary_conditions": [
    "hip_condition",
    "knee_condition_left",
    "knee_condition_right",
    "peripheral_neuropathy",
    "erectile_dysfunction",
    "sleep_impairment",
    "depression",
    "anxiety",
],
"exam_tips": [
    "Flare-ups: Tell the examiner what your range of motion is DURING a f
    "Painful motion: Under § 4.59, even painful motion at normal range ca
    "Muscle spasms that cause abnormal gait can qualify for a 10% rating
    "Do NOT stretch or do exercises before your C&P exam.",
    "Mention every daily activity affected: bending to tie shoes, sitting
    "If you have radiating leg pain, this should be rated separately as s
],
"nexus_tips": [
    "Document the specific in-service cause: ruck marching, heavy lifting
    "Army/Marine infantry, combat engineers, and airborne veterans have s
],
},

"knee_condition_left": {
    "name": "Left Knee Condition",
    "diagnostic_code": "5260",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5255-5263",
    "rating_criteria": {
        30: "Slight instability: 10-20° (or in a presumptive/favorable direct
        20: "Moderate instability: lateral movement of more than 1cm but less
        10: "Slight instability: lateral movement to 1 cm, OR limitation of e
        0: "Objective evidence without swelling or instability, OR limitatio
    },
    "key_measurements": [
        "Flexion (normal: 0-140°)",
        "Extension (normal: 0°)",
        "Lateral stability (laxity in mm)",
        "Anterior-posterior stability",
        "Meniscal tenderness",
        "Crepitus (grinding/popping)",
    ],
    "dbq_questions": [
        "What is the range of flexion and extension in your left knee?",
        "Does your knee give way or feel unstable when walking or climbing st

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        "Do you have locking, buckling, or popping of the knee?",
        "Do you have swelling or effusion in the knee?",
        "Have you had any surgery on this knee (meniscus, ACL, etc.)?",
        "Does the pain affect your ability to stand for extended periods, kne
        "Do you have pain on motion (even at the beginning of movement)?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "hip_condition",
        "lumbosacral_strain",
        "ankle_condition_left",
        "sleep_impairment",
        "depression",
    ],
    "bilateral_pair": "knee_condition_right",
    "exam_tips": [
        "Request bilateral ratings if BOTH knees are affected – the bilateral
        "Pain on motion at the BEGINNING of movement can qualify for a rating
        "Crepitus documented alone can support at least a 10% rating.",
        "Instability and limitation of flexion are rated separately under dif
        "If you have had surgery, request a convalescent rating (38 CFR § 4.3
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Document in-service incidents: injury during PT, field training, jum
        "Overuse from ruck marching, extended patrols, or frequent stair clim
    ],
},

"knee_condition_right": {
    "name": "Right Knee Condition",
    "diagnostic_code": "5260",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5255-5263",
    "rating_criteria": {
        30: "Limitation of extension to 20° or more, OR significant instabili
        20: "Limitation of extension to between 11° and 20°, OR moderate inst
        10: "Limitation of extension to between 6° and 10°, OR limitation of
        0: "Objective evidence without swelling or instability",
    },
    "key_measurements": [
        "Flexion (normal: 0-140°)",
        "Extension (normal: 0°)",
        "Lateral stability",
        "Crepitus",
    ],
    "dbq_questions": [
        "What is the range of flexion and extension in your right knee?",
        "Does your knee give way or feel unstable?",
    ]
}

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        "Do you have swelling or effusion?",
        "Does the pain affect your ability to stand, kneel, or climb?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "hip_condition",
        "lumbosacral_strain",
        "ankle_condition_right",
    ],
    "bilateral_pair": "knee_condition_left",
    "exam_tips": [
        "Always evaluate alongside left knee – bilateral factor applies if bo",
        "Painful motion at initial range of motion qualifies under § 4.59.",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Same as left knee – document specific in-service cause.",
    ],
},

"shoulder_condition_left": {
    "name": "Left Shoulder Condition",
    "diagnostic_code": "5201",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5200-5203",
    "rating_criteria": {
        40: "Motion limited to 25° from the side (dominant) / 30° from side (",
        30: "Motion limited to 25° from side (non-dominant)",
        20: "Motion limited midway between side and shoulder level (to 45°)",
        10: "Motion limited to shoulder level (to 90°), dominant / midway non",
    },
    "key_measurements": [
        "Forward flexion (normal: 180°)",
        "Abduction (normal: 180°)",
        "Internal rotation",
        "External rotation",
    ],
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Can you raise your left arm above your head?",
        "What angle can you abduct (raise to the side) your left arm before p",
        "Do you have rotator cuff damage, tears, or labral tears?",
        "Does the shoulder affect your ability to carry, lift, or reach?",
        "Do you have clicking, popping, or grinding in the shoulder?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "cervical_strain",
        "peripheral_neuropathy",
        "sleep_impairment",
    ],
},

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```

    "bilateral_pair": "shoulder_condition_right",
    "exam_tips": [
        "Dominant vs. non-dominant matters – dominant arm is rated higher. Sp",
        "Measure abduction at point of pain onset, not maximum achievable.",
        "Rotator cuff tears and SLAP tears have their own DCs – ensure all ar",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Repetitive overhead lifting, carrying heavy rucksacks, parachute ope",
    ],
},

```

```

"shoulder_condition_right": {
    "name": "Right Shoulder Condition",
    "diagnostic_code": "5201",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5200-5203",
    "rating_criteria": {
        40: "Motion limited to 25° from the side (dominant)",
        30: "Motion limited to 25° from side (non-dominant) or 30° dominant",
        20: "Motion limited to 45° dominant / non-dominant 30°",
        10: "Motion limited to 90° shoulder level",
    },
    "key_measurements": ["Forward flexion", "Abduction", "Internal rotation",
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Can you raise your right arm above your head?",
        "What angle can you raise the right arm before pain stops you?",
        "Is the right arm your dominant arm?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["cervical_strain", "peripheral_neuropathy"],
    "bilateral_pair": "shoulder_condition_left",
    "exam_tips": ["Dominant arm rating is higher – confirm and document domin",
    "nexus_tips": ["Document specific in-service shoulder injury or repetitiv",
},

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"plantar_fasciitis_left": {
    "name": "Left Plantar Fasciitis / Pes Planus",
    "diagnostic_code": "5276",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5276-5284",
    "rating_criteria": {
        50: "Pronounced: marked pronation, extreme tenderness of plantar surf",
        30: "Severe: objective evidence of marked deformity (pronation, abduc",
        10: "Moderate: weight-bearing line over or medial to great toe, inwar",
        0: "Mild: symptoms relieved by built-up shoe or arch support",
    },
    "key_measurements": ["Arch height", "Pronation degree", "Tenderness on pa",
    "dbq_questions": [

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        "Do you have pain on the bottom of your foot when standing or walking
        "Is the pain worse in the morning or after long periods of standing?"
        "Do you have calluses or deformity of the foot?",
        "Do orthotics or special shoes help – and are they required for you t
        "Does the condition affect your ability to stand for extended periods
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["knee_condition_left", "lumbosacral_strain", "an
    "bilateral_pair": "plantar_fasciitis_right",
    "exam_tips": [
        "Do NOT wear orthotics to the C&P exam – they can reduce the severity
        "Walk barefoot for the examiner so they can observe the pronation and
        "Mention how long you can stand before pain forces you to sit.",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Military boots, ruck marching, standing at parade rest, and running
        "MOSS with high physical demand (infantry, MP, logistics) have strong
    ],
},

```

```

"plantar_fasciitis_right": {
    "name": "Right Plantar Fasciitis / Pes Planus",
    "diagnostic_code": "5276",
    "body_system": "musculoskeletal",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.71a, DC 5276",
    "rating_criteria": {
        50: "Pronounced: extreme tenderness, marked deformity, characteristic
        30: "Severe: marked deformity, pain on manipulation and use",
        10: "Moderate: pain on use, inward bowing of tendo achilles",
        0: "Mild: relieved by built-up shoe",
    },
    "key_measurements": ["Arch height", "Tenderness", "Callus formation"],
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Do you have pain on the bottom of your right foot?",
        "Do orthotics help – and are they required?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["knee_condition_right", "lumbosacral_strain"],
    "bilateral_pair": "plantar_fasciitis_left",
    "exam_tips": ["Same as left – do NOT wear orthotics to exam."],
    "nexus_tips": ["Document specific military duties that caused overuse."],
},

```

```

# _____
# MENTAL HEALTH (DC 9200-9440)
# _____

```

```

"ptsd": {
    "name": "Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD)",

```

```
"diagnostic_code": "9411",
"body_system": "mental_health",
"cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.130, DC 9411",
"rating_criteria": {
  100: "Total occupational and social impairment, due to such symptoms
  70:  "Occupational and social impairment with deficiencies in most ar
  50:  "Occupational and social impairment with reduced reliability and
  30:  "Occupational and social impairment with occasional decrease in
  10:  "Occupational and social impairment due to mild or transient sym
  0:   "A mental condition has been formally diagnosed, but symptoms ar
},
"dbq_questions": [
  "Describe your stressor event(s) that occurred during military servic
  "Do you have recurrent, intrusive memories, nightmares, or flashbacks
  "Do you avoid people, places, or activities that remind you of the tr
  "Do you experience hypervigilance – being constantly on guard, easily
  "Do you have sleep disturbances – difficulty falling asleep, staying
  "Have you had thoughts of harming yourself or others?",
  "How has PTSD affected your work performance, relationships, and soci
  "Do you have panic attacks – and how often do they occur?",
  "Have you isolated yourself from friends or family?",
  "Are you currently in treatment – therapy, medication, or both?",
],
"secondary_conditions": [
  "depression",
  "anxiety",
  "sleep_impairment",
  "substance_abuse",
  "tbi",
  "erectile_dysfunction",
  "hypertension",
  "irritable_bowel",
],
"exam_tips": [
  "Describe your WORST symptoms – not your best day.",
  "Use specific examples: 'I have nightmares 4-5 nights per week', 'I h
  "Describe how it affects your WORK: missed days, inability to concent
  "Describe how it affects your RELATIONSHIPS: isolation, anger, inabil
  "If you take medication, note that symptoms are NOT fully controlled
  "Bring a buddy statement or spouse/family statement documenting behav
  "If you have suicidal ideation (even passive), disclose this – it is
],
"nexus_tips": [
  "PTSD requires a documented in-service stressor – this can be combat,
  "For combat veterans, the stressor is presumed credible if the vetera
  "MST stressors do not require official documentation – your own state
  "A private DBQ completed by your treating psychiatrist or psychologis
```



```

    ],
  },

  "depression": {
    "name": "Major Depressive Disorder",
    "diagnostic_code": "9434",
    "body_system": "mental_health",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.130, DC 9434",
    "rating_criteria": {
      100: "Total occupational and social impairment",
      70: "Occupational and social impairment with deficiencies in most ar
      50: "Occupational and social impairment with reduced reliability and
      30: "Occupational and social impairment with occasional decrease in
      10: "Mild or transient symptoms controlled by medication or only pre
      0: "Formally diagnosed but not interfering with functioning",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
      "How many days per week do you feel depressed or hopeless?",
      "Have you lost interest in activities you used to enjoy?",
      "Do you have difficulty concentrating or making decisions?",
      "Has your sleep or appetite changed significantly?",
      "Have you had thoughts of suicide or self-harm?",
      "How has depression affected your ability to work and maintain relati
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["ptsd", "anxiety", "sleep_impairment", "chronic_
    "exam_tips": [
      "If depression is secondary to a physical condition (back pain, TBI,
      "Describe ALL occupational impacts: missed work, inability to focus,
      "GAF (Global Assessment of Functioning) score below 50 generally supp
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
      "Depression secondary to a service-connected condition (e.g., PTSD, c
    ],
  },

  "anxiety": {
    "name": "Generalized Anxiety Disorder",
    "diagnostic_code": "9400",
    "body_system": "mental_health",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.130, DC 9400",
    "rating_criteria": {
      100: "Total occupational and social impairment",
      70: "Occupational and social impairment with deficiencies in most ar
      50: "Panic attacks more than once a week, difficulty with complex co
      30: "Panic attacks weekly or less, chronic sleep impairment, mild me
      10: "Mild or transient symptoms controlled by medication",
      0: "Formally diagnosed, not interfering with functioning",
    }
  }
}

```

```

    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Do you have panic attacks – how often and how severe?",
        "Do you experience excessive worry that you cannot control?",
        "Do you have physical symptoms: racing heart, sweating, trembling?",
        "Does anxiety prevent you from going to certain places or doing certa
        "How does anxiety affect your work and personal life?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["ptsd", "depression", "sleep_impairment", "hyper
    "exam_tips": [
        "Frequency and severity of panic attacks is the key metric – track th
        "Note if anxiety has caused you to avoid situations (crowds, driving,
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Can be claimed directly or as secondary to PTSD, TBI, or chronic pai
    ],
},

"tbi": {
    "name": "Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI)",
    "diagnostic_code": "8045",
    "body_system": "mental_health",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.124a, DC 8045",
    "rating_criteria": {
        100: "Severe TBI: one or more of the following – vegetative state, pe
        70: "Moderately severe: severely impaired memory, judgment, thinking
        50: "Moderate: occupational/social impairment with reduced reliabili
        30: "Mild: occasional decrease in work efficiency; mild memory loss,
        10: "Mild or transient: symptoms only during stress or controlled by
        0: "Formally diagnosed but not interfering with functioning",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Were you exposed to a blast, explosion, or blow to the head during s
        "Did you lose consciousness – and for how long?",
        "Do you have persistent headaches – how frequent and severe?",
        "Do you have memory problems, difficulty concentrating, or confusion?
        "Do you have changes in mood, personality, or behavior since the inju
        "Do you have sensitivity to light or sound?",
        "Do you have sleep disturbances related to the TBI?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "ptsd",
        "depression",
        "anxiety",
        "headaches_migraines",
        "sleep_impairment",
        "tinnitus",
    ],

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```

        "hearing_loss",
    ],
    "exam_tips": [
        "TBI symptoms overlap with PTSD – both should be evaluated and rated",
        "Headaches from TBI are rated separately as DC 8100 (Migraine/Headach",
        "Cognitive deficits should be documented through neuropsychological t",
        "Note ALL symptoms even if mild – TBI is rated on the combined pictur",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Blast exposure in combat zones (IED, mortar, artillery) is a common",
        "Military records of LOC (loss of consciousness) or being evaluated f",
    ],
},

```

```

# _____
# AUDIOLOGY & VISION
# _____

```

```

"tinnitus": {
    "name": "Tinnitus (Ringing in Ears)",
    "diagnostic_code": "6260",
    "body_system": "audiology",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.87, DC 6260",
    "rating_criteria": {
        10: "Tinnitus recurrent – rated as a single disability whether the co",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Do you have constant or intermittent ringing, buzzing, or hissing in",
        "Is it in one or both ears?",
        "How does tinnitus affect your sleep, concentration, or daily activit",
        "Was noise exposure (gunfire, explosions, aircraft, machinery) part o",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "hearing_loss",
        "sleep_impairment",
        "depression",
        "anxiety",
    ],
    "exam_tips": [
        "Tinnitus is limited to 10% but is one of the most commonly granted c",
        "Bilateral tinnitus is still rated at 10% total.",
        "It combines with hearing loss for a higher total – claim both togeth",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Weapons qualification, aircraft proximity, combat, demolitions, or i",
        "MOS-based noise exposure is well-documented – infantry, armor, aviat",
    ],
}

```

```

},

"hearing_loss": {
  "name": "Sensorineural Hearing Loss",
  "diagnostic_code": "6100",
  "body_system": "audiology",
  "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.85-4.87, DC 6100",
  "rating_criteria": {
    100: "SX speech discrimination + Roman numeral combination per 38 CFR
    80: "Per Table VI – severe impairment",
    60: "Per Table VI – marked impairment",
    40: "Per Table VI – moderate impairment",
    20: "Per Table VI – mild to moderate impairment",
    10: "Per Table VI – mild impairment in both ears",
    0: "Puretone average and speech discrimination within normal limits
  },
  "dbq_questions": [
    "Do you have difficulty understanding speech in noisy environments?",
    "Do you need to ask people to repeat themselves frequently?",
    "Have you had a formal audiological evaluation – and what were the re
    "Do you use hearing aids?",
    "Was noise a significant part of your military service (weapons, airc
  ],
  "secondary_conditions": ["tinnitus", "depression", "anxiety"],
  "exam_tips": [
    "The audiologist will conduct a puretone average and speech discrimin
    "Hearing aids may HELP but do not disqualify you – the rating is base
    "Request the examiner document your WORST ear results.",
  ],
  "nexus_tips": [
    "In-service audiogram showing normal hearing at entry, then degraded
    "MOS/specialty codes with known noise exposure are typically sufficie
  ],
},

```

```

# _____
# RESPIRATORY SYSTEM
# _____

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```

"sleep_apnea": {
  "name": "Obstructive Sleep Apnea",
  "diagnostic_code": "6847",
  "body_system": "respiratory",
  "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.97, DC 6847",
  "rating_criteria": {
    100: "Chronic respiratory failure with carbon dioxide retention, or c
    50: "Requires use of breathing assistance device such as CPAP machin

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        30: "Persistent daytime hypersomnolence",
        0: "Asymptomatic but with documented sleep disorder breathing",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Have you been diagnosed with sleep apnea via a sleep study (polysomn",
        "Do you use a CPAP, BiPAP, or other breathing device at night?",
        "Do you have excessive daytime sleepiness despite using the device?",
        "Do you snore loudly or stop breathing during sleep (as reported by o",
        "Did your sleep problems begin or worsen during military service?",
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [
        "hypertension",
        "depression",
        "ptsd",
        "heart_condition",
    ],
    "exam_tips": [
        "A CPAP prescription alone qualifies for 50% – this is one of the mos",
        "Make sure your sleep study results are in your records.",
        "If daytime sleepiness persists DESPITE CPAP, document this – it supp",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Sleep apnea as secondary to PTSD, TBI, or other mental health condit",
        "Weight gain during service that contributed to sleep apnea can suppo",
    ],
},

```

```

# _____
# CARDIOVASCULAR SYSTEM
# _____

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```

"hypertension": {
    "name": "Hypertension (High Blood Pressure)",
    "diagnostic_code": "7101",
    "body_system": "cardiovascular",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.104, DC 7101",
    "rating_criteria": {
        60: "Diastolic pressure predominantly 130 or more",
        40: "Diastolic pressure predominantly 120 or more",
        20: "Diastolic pressure predominantly 110 or more, or systolic pressu",
        10: "Diastolic pressure predominantly 100 or more, or systolic pressu",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "What is your typical blood pressure reading (systolic/diastolic)?",
        "Are you on medication to control your blood pressure?",
        "How long have you had hypertension?",
        "Were elevated blood pressure readings documented during your service",
    ],
}

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        "Do you have any end-organ damage (kidney disease, heart disease, eye
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["ptsd", "sleep_apnea", "anxiety", "heart_conditi
    "exam_tips": [
        "Multiple readings are taken – do NOT take blood pressure medication
        "Bring records of your highest documented readings.",
        "If you require medication for control, that alone qualifies for 10%
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Hypertension secondary to PTSD or anxiety is a well-established seco
        "In-service readings showing elevated BP are strong direct nexus evid
    ],
},

# _____
# SKIN
# _____

"dermatitis": {
    "name": "Dermatitis / Eczema",
    "diagnostic_code": "7806",
    "body_system": "skin",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.118, DC 7806",
    "rating_criteria": {
        60: "More than 40 percent of the entire body or more than 40 percent
        30: "20 to 40 percent of the entire body or 20 to 40 percent of expos
        10: "At least 5 percent, but less than 20 percent, of the entire body
        0: "Less than 5 percent of the entire body or less than 5 percent of
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "What percentage of your body is affected by the skin condition?",
        "Do you require systemic medication (oral steroids, immunosuppressant
        "How often do you have flare-ups?",
        "Do you use only topical treatments, or systemic (pill/injection) tre
        "Were you exposed to chemicals, environmental hazards, or burn pits d
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": [],
    "exam_tips": [
        "Do NOT apply topical treatments on the day of the exam – show the co
        "The percentage of body surface affected is key – measure and documen
        "Systemic medication requirement is the biggest rating driver.",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Burn pit exposure, chemical exposure, or tropical deployment are com
        "FACT Act (2022) creates presumptives for many skin conditions from b
    ],
},

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# -----
# GENITOURINARY / OTHER
# -----

"erectile_dysfunction": {
  "name": "Erectile Dysfunction",
  "diagnostic_code": "7522",
  "body_system": "genitourinary",
  "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.115b, DC 7522",
  "rating_criteria": {
    0: "Rated as 0% with a Special Monthly Compensation (SMC) entitlement",
  },
  "dbq_questions": [
    "Have you been diagnosed with erectile dysfunction by a physician?",
    "Do you take medication (Viagra, Cialis, etc.) or use devices to manage",
    "Has this condition been associated with your service-connected condition?",
  ],
  "secondary_conditions": ["ptsd", "depression", "lumbosacral_strain", "hypertension"],
  "exam_tips": [
    "Erectile dysfunction is rated 0% but triggers Special Monthly Compensation",
    "SMC-k adds significant monthly compensation even at 0% – do NOT skip",
    "Claim as secondary to PTSD, spinal cord injury, prostate condition, or",
  ],
  "nexus_tips": [
    "Secondary to PTSD, lumbar spine conditions with nerve involvement, or",
  ],
},

"sleep_impairment": {
  "name": "Sleep Impairment (Secondary Condition)",
  "diagnostic_code": "None",
  "body_system": "mental_health",
  "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.130",
  "rating_criteria": {
    0: "Sleep impairment is typically rated as a symptom within the mental health",
  },
  "dbq_questions": [
    "How many hours of sleep do you get per night?",
    "How often do you wake during the night?",
    "Do nightmares or hypervigilance prevent sleep?",
    "Does poor sleep affect your daytime functioning?",
  ],
  "secondary_conditions": [],
  "exam_tips": [
    "Sleep impairment boosts the rating for PTSD, depression, and TBI – do not",
    "If sleep apnea is the primary issue, file DC 6847 separately for a 5

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    ],
    "nexus_tips": [],
},

"headaches_migraines": {
    "name": "Migraine Headaches",
    "diagnostic_code": "8100",
    "body_system": "neurological",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.124a, DC 8100",
    "rating_criteria": {
        50: "With very frequent completely prostrating and prolonged attacks
        30: "With characteristic prostrating attacks occurring on an average
        10: "With characteristic prostrating attacks averaging one in 2 month
        0: "With less frequent attacks",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "How frequently do you have headaches – per week or per month?",
        "Are the headaches prostrating – do they force you to stop all activi
        "How long does each headache last?",
        "Have headaches caused you to miss work or fail to perform occupation
        "Are they associated with nausea, light/sound sensitivity, or visual
        "Are headaches related to a TBI, cervical strain, or other service-co
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["tbi", "cervical_strain", "ptsd", "depression"],
    "exam_tips": [
        "Frequency and prostration are everything – document EVERY headache i
        "Prostrating means you had to stop ALL activity – lying down, unable
        "If migraines are caused by your TBI or neck condition, claim as seco
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "TBI from blast exposure is a well-established nexus for migraines.",
        "Cervical strain causing tension headaches can also support nexus.",
    ],
},

"peripheral_neuropathy": {
    "name": "Peripheral Neuropathy",
    "diagnostic_code": "8515",
    "body_system": "neurological",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.124a, DC 8510-8730",
    "rating_criteria": {
        40: "Complete paralysis of the nerve",
        20: "Incomplete paralysis of the nerve, moderate",
        10: "Incomplete paralysis of the nerve, mild",
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "Do you have numbness, tingling, or burning in your hands or feet?",

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        "Is the sensation loss constant or intermittent?",
        "Do you have weakness in the affected limbs?",
        "Has the neuropathy affected your ability to grip, walk, or perform f
        "Is the neuropathy associated with your back condition, diabetes, or
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["lumbosacral_strain", "cervical_strain", "diabet
    "exam_tips": [
        "Peripheral neuropathy is rated per nerve and per limb – each affecte
        "If caused by your back condition, claim as secondary.",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "Commonly secondary to lumbar or cervical radiculopathy.",
        "Agent Orange exposure creates presumptive peripheral neuropathy for
    ],
},

"irritable_bowel": {
    "name": "Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS)",
    "diagnostic_code": "7319",
    "body_system": "digestive",
    "cfr_reference": "38 CFR § 4.114, DC 7319",
    "rating_criteria": {
        30: "Severe; diarrhea, or alternating diarrhea and constipation, with
        10: "Moderate; frequent episodes of bowel disturbance with abdominal
        0: "Mild; disturbances of bowel function with occasional episodes of
    },
    "dbq_questions": [
        "How frequent are episodes of diarrhea or constipation?",
        "Do you have constant or near-constant abdominal pain or cramping?",
        "Has IBS caused you to miss work or avoid social situations?",
        "Is the condition related to your PTSD, anxiety, or another service-c
    ],
    "secondary_conditions": ["ptsd", "anxiety", "depression"],
    "exam_tips": [
        "Frequency and constancy of symptoms drive the rating – document dail
        "Secondary to PTSD or anxiety is a strong claim basis.",
    ],
    "nexus_tips": [
        "IBS secondary to PTSD is well-recognized – cite the gut-brain axis c
    ],
},
}

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# -----
# BODY SYSTEM MENU STRUCTURE
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BODY_SYSTEMS = {
  "musculoskeletal": {
    "label": "Musculoskeletal System (Back, Knees, Shoulders, Feet, etc.)",
    "conditions": [
      "lumbosacral_strain",
      "cervical_strain",
      "knee_condition_left",
      "knee_condition_right",
      "shoulder_condition_left",
      "shoulder_condition_right",
      "plantar_fasciitis_left",
      "plantar_fasciitis_right",
    ],
  },
  "mental_health": {
    "label": "Mental Health (PTSD, Depression, Anxiety, TBI)",
    "conditions": [
      "ptsd",
      "depression",
      "anxiety",
      "tbi",
      "sleep_impairment",
    ],
  },
  "audiology": {
    "label": "Audiology & Vision (Hearing Loss, Tinnitus)",
    "conditions": [
      "tinnitus",
      "hearing_loss",
    ],
  },
  "respiratory": {
    "label": "Respiratory System (Sleep Apnea, Asthma)",
    "conditions": [
      "sleep_apnea",
    ],
  },
  "cardiovascular": {
    "label": "Cardiovascular System (Hypertension, Heart Conditions)",
    "conditions": [
      "hypertension",
    ],
  },
  "skin": {
    "label": "Skin Conditions (Dermatitis, Burn Pit Related)",
    "conditions": [
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        "dermatitis",
    ],
},
"genitourinary": {
    "label": "Genitourinary System",
    "conditions": [
        "erectile_dysfunction",
    ],
},
"neurological": {
    "label": "Neurological (Migraines, Peripheral Neuropathy)",
    "conditions": [
        "headaches_migraines",
        "peripheral_neuropathy",
    ],
},
"digestive": {
    "label": "Digestive System (IBS, GERD)",
    "conditions": [
        "irritable_bowel",
    ],
},
}

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# _____
# SECONDARY CONDITION MAP
# _____

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SECONDARY_PROMPTS = {
    "lumbosacral_strain": [
        ("hip_condition", "Lower back conditions commonly cause hip misalignment.
        ("knee_condition_left", "Back problems can alter gait and stress the knee
        ("knee_condition_right", "Back problems can alter gait and stress the kne
        ("peripheral_neuropathy", "Lumbar spine conditions can compress nerves ca
        ("erectile_dysfunction", "Lumbar nerve compression can cause erectile dys
        ("depression", "Chronic pain frequently causes depression. Have you exper
        ("sleep_impairment", "Chronic pain disrupts sleep. Do you have significan
    ],
    "ptsd": [
        ("depression", "PTSD and depression commonly co-occur. Do you also experi
        ("anxiety", "Anxiety disorders frequently co-occur with PTSD. Do you have
        ("sleep_apnea", "PTSD disrupts sleep patterns and is linked to sleep apne
        ("hypertension", "PTSD causes chronic stress responses linked to high blo
        ("irritable_bowel", "PTSD affects the gut-brain axis and can cause IBS. D
        ("erectile_dysfunction", "PTSD and its medications commonly cause erectil
        ("tinnitus", "Combat stress and hypervigilance often accompany tinnitus.
    ]
}

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],
"tbi": [
    ("ptsd", "TBI and PTSD frequently co-occur in combat veterans. Have you b
    ("headaches_migraines", "TBI is a primary cause of persistent migraines.
    ("sleep_impairment", "TBI commonly disrupts sleep architecture. Do you ha
    ("depression", "TBI frequently causes depression. Have you experienced pe
    ("tinnitus", "Blast-related TBI commonly causes tinnitus. Do you have rin
    ("hearing_loss", "Blast TBI frequently causes hearing damage. Have you ha
],
"knee_condition_left": [
    ("lumbosacral_strain", "Knee conditions alter gait and can cause lower ba
    ("hip_condition", "Knee problems shift weight to the hip. Do you have hip
],
"sleep_apnea": [
    ("hypertension", "Sleep apnea is a major contributor to hypertension. Hav
    ("depression", "Sleep apnea causes fatigue and depressive symptoms. Do yo
],
}
```